

PURPOSE: To propose an intermediate privilege plan between the “O” plan and “premium” plan to provide more privileges to responsible juniors and seniors (during their first nine-weeks) and to bring attention to the fact that even if juniors have a higher eligibility criteria than the premium plan, they can not gain more privileges.

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BE IT RESOLVED BY THE MISSISSIPPI SCHOOL FOR MATHEMATICS AND SCIENCE SENATE:

SECTION ONE (REASONING):

MSMS is a school which requires its students to manage many different responsibilities such as following the rules of the student handbook, maintaining grades, keeping dorm rooms clean, cleaning campus through work service, etc. Once a student shows that he or she can sustain these responsibilities, he or she is given a privilege plan that awards the student with certain privileges such as less required study hours, longer sign out time, and more frequent car usage based on his or her performance at MSMS. Seniors’ highest privilege plan (the “O” plan) has a higher eligibility criteria and more privileges such as an hour longer weekend sign-out limit, one more day free from study hours, and more frequent car usage throughout the week than the juniors’ highest privilege plan (the junior “Premium” plan). For example, to obtain the “O” plan, seniors must have the following eligibility criteria: maintain a grade average of all A’s, have no more than two level one written warnings and no level two or level three’s, and have an “outstanding rating” on their work service, residential living, and wellness; to obtain the “Premium” plan, juniors must maintain a grade average of 87-92.99 and have two “outstanding” ratings and one “satisfactory” on their work service, residential living, and wellness. This difference shows that juniors who have the same eligibility criteria as seniors will still not be allowed the same privileges mentioned before despite displaying the same responsibility.

Because MSMS does not allow parents to give more permission to students than MSMS allows and because the MSMS rules and responsibilities already come as a shock to most students, MSMS should strive to make not only current but also future MSMS students feel comfortable in its environment when students show that they are responsible members of the community. Juniors and seniors (during their first nine weeks) may not have more privileges than the premium plan awards even though they may have higher grades, fewer violations, and better ratings than the eligibility criteria for the “premium” plan. This fact is unfair towards students who have demonstrated their capabilities and dedication to MSMS, and they should be offered a plan with higher privileges.

SECTION 2 (PROPOSED ACTION):

Because the student handbook states that parents can give less permissions but never more to MSMS students and because students are in a new and strict environment, MSMS should strive to make current and future students feel as comfortable as possible. MSMS can make students feel more comfortable by giving students as many privileges as it can depending on the responsibility of students. I propose that an intermediate plan is made between the “O” plan and “premium” plan to provide juniors and seniors during their first nine-weeks with a fairer attainable privilege plan.

SECTION 3 (APPENDIX):

***All responses are anonymous**

Response 1 (Former Student):

If I had read the privilege plan section of the student handbook prior to coming to MSMS, I probably would not have come.

Response 2 (Current Student):

Because this is not only our school but our home, we need to feel like our life can be more flexible and can have more opportunities to do things that may be restricted. Just because we're juniors I understand we might not have the same privileges as seniors, but we should still have the ability to gain more privileges because it is already hard here.

Response 3 (Current Student):

We should be able to be given more privileges after the first nine-weeks. I am integrated in this community just as seniors are. I have the ability to handle more privileges if I have shown responsibility because I am just as much as a part of this community.